



Foreign, Commonwealth & Development Office (FCDO) – Global PMO Management

As PMO Manager for the Foreign, Commonwealth & Development Office (FCDO), I led the governance and delivery oversight of a global IT project portfolio operating across multiple security classifications — Official, Secret, and Top Secret.

The role demanded exceptional coordination across a multi-MSP environment, each delivering distinct managed-service operational lines into BAE Systems, the sole service integrator for the FCDO's technology ecosystem.

Programme Environment

The engagement operated within one of the UK Government's most complex delivery landscapes — a multi-vendor, multi-disciplinary environment supporting secure global operations.

Key characteristics:

- Multiple Managed Service Providers (MSPs) delivering BAU support across diverse technology domains
- Integration through BAE Systems as the single service integrator
- Global delivery footprint spanning secure and classified networks
- Projects ranging from infrastructure upgrades to cyber-security and collaboration platforms

This environment required robust governance, precise coordination, and disciplined assurance to maintain operational integrity across all service lines.

Portfolio Governance & Assurance

I established and managed the governance framework for the entire project portfolio, ensuring compliance with FCDO, BAE Systems, and Cabinet Office standards.

Responsibilities:

- Oversight of project lifecycle from initiation to closure
- SLA management and performance tracking across MSPs
- Risk, issue, and dependency management across classified domains
- Assurance reviews and reporting to senior government stakeholders
- Continuous improvement of delivery processes and governance artefacts

This framework provided transparency, accountability, and delivery confidence across a highly regulated environment.

Stakeholder & Vendor Management

Operating within a multi-vendor and multi-agency ecosystem, I managed relationships across government officials, service integrator teams, and third-party suppliers.

Stakeholder groups:

- BAE Systems (Service Integrator)
- Multiple MSPs delivering operational support
- Senior government officials and departmental leads
- Security and compliance authorities

Through structured engagement and clear communication channels, I ensured alignment between strategic objectives and operational execution.

Leadership & Resource Management

I provided direct line management and matrix leadership across a diverse technical and delivery workforce.

Line management:

- 2 × Business Analysts
- 1 × Change Analyst
- 10 × Project Managers
- 2 × Project Coordinators
- 15 × Technical Consultants

Matrix management:

- Wintel Engineers
- Network Engineers
- Messaging & Collaboration Engineers
- Security Engineers

This structure enabled efficient resource utilisation, cross-functional collaboration, and consistent delivery standards across all workstreams.

Outcomes & Impact

- Established unified PMO governance across multi-MSP environment
- Improved SLA compliance and delivery predictability
- Enhanced visibility of global project portfolio performance
- Strengthened collaboration between FCDO, BAE Systems, and third-party vendors
- Delivered assured outcomes across Official, Secret, and Top Secret domains

Strategic Contribution

The engagement delivered a mature, secure, and integrated PMO capability supporting the FCDO's global mission.

It reinforced governance discipline, improved service integration, and ensured delivery excellence across one of the UK Government's most complex technology portfolios.